

PremierDrive

School of Motoring

Approved Driving Instructor (ADI) Training -- Manchester, UK

Knowledge Base & Customer Policy Document

AI Customer Assistant Reference Manual -- For RAG Ingestion

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This document is the authoritative knowledge base for PremierDrive's AI customer support chatbot. It covers all services, lesson packages, pricing, theory and practical test guidance, policies, and FAQs. Content is accurate as of September 2026. Update annually or when pricing/policy changes.

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This document is structured to answer customer questions accurately via our AI chatbot. Instructors and staff should direct customers to the chatbot for pricing and policy queries. Any information not covered here should be escalated to the school manager.

Section 1 -- About PremierDrive School of Motoring

PremierDrive School of Motoring is one of Greater Manchester's most trusted and established driving schools, founded in 2007. We are a DVSA-registered driving school with over 4,200 pupils passed since opening. Our instructors are fully qualified Approved Driving Instructors (ADIs) registered with the Driver and Vehicle Standards Agency (DVSA).

We specialise in delivering high-quality, pupil-centred driving tuition for learner drivers aged 17 and above. Whether you are a complete beginner, returning driver needing a refresher, or a business looking to upskill your fleet, PremierDrive has a programme tailored to your needs.

Our Mission

To provide safe, structured, and enjoyable driving tuition that produces confident, responsible drivers who pass first time and remain safe for life on the road. We follow the DVSA's Approved Driving Instructor standards and the National Standard for Driver and Rider Training.

Why Choose PremierDrive?

- 5-star average Google rating -- over 1,100 verified reviews.
- 82% first-time pass rate -- consistently above the national average of 47%.
- Fully DBS-checked instructors -- every instructor holds a valid enhanced DBS certificate.
- Dual-controlled vehicles -- every lesson car is fitted with an instructor brake and clutch pedal.
- Flexible scheduling -- evenings, weekends, and early mornings available.
- Female instructors available -- on request, subject to area and availability.
- Pick-up and drop-off from home, school, college, or workplace.
- Student discounts available -- 5% off block bookings of 10 hours or more for full-time students.
- Structured progress reports after every lesson -- accessible via the PremierDrive app.

Accreditations & Registrations

- DVSA Approved Driving School -- Registration No. ADI-GB-2019-04471.
- Driving Instructors Association (DIA) corporate member.
- Motor Schools Association of Great Britain (MSA) member.
- All vehicles: MOT valid, fully comprehensively insured, dual-controlled.

Our Values

Safety first -- every lesson is taught in accordance with DVSA guidelines and The Highway Code. We do not rush pupils to test before they are ready. Our instructors will advise honestly on test-readiness, and we will never pressure a pupil to book a test date prematurely.

Section 2 -- Our Instructors & ADI Qualifications

All PremierDrive instructors hold a current Grade A or Grade B ADI licence issued by the DVSA. To qualify as an ADI, an instructor must pass three rigorous examinations: a theory test (ADI Part 1), a practical driving ability test (ADI Part 2), and an instructional ability test (ADI Part 3). The entire qualification process typically takes 12-18 months and has a pass rate of around 30% nationally, reflecting the high standard required.

ADI Grades Explained

- Grade A -- Outstanding instructional ability. Highest DVSA grade. Majority of our instructors hold Grade A.
- Grade B -- Good instructional ability. Meets all DVSA requirements for unsupervised ADI work.
- PDI (Trainee) -- Instructor in training, working under a franchise. Always accompanied by a qualified supervisor. PremierDrive does NOT currently employ PDIs for solo pupil lessons.

Instructor DBS & Safeguarding

Every instructor holds a valid Enhanced Disclosure and Barring Service (DBS) check renewed every 3 years or sooner if required. All instructors have completed a DVSA-approved safeguarding awareness course. Pupils under 18 may be asked for parental consent forms before lessons commence.

Instructor-Pupil Matching

When you book with PremierDrive, we assign you an instructor based on your location, preferred lesson times, and vehicle type (manual or automatic). If you have a specific instructor preference, or wish to change your instructor for any reason, contact us and we will arrange this at no additional cost, subject to availability.

Section 3 -- Areas We Cover Across Greater Manchester

PremierDrive covers all major areas of Greater Manchester and surrounding towns. Lessons begin and end at your chosen pick-up point within our operating zone.

Primary coverage areas include:

- Manchester City Centre, Salford, Stretford, Trafford
- Didsbury, Withington, Chorlton, Wythenshawe
- Stockport, Cheadle, Bramhall, Hazel Grove
- Oldham, Rochdale, Bury, Bolton
- Altrincham, Sale, Urmston, Eccles
- Ashton-under-Lyne, Hyde, Denton

Not sure if we cover your area? Call 0161 555 0291 or use the postcode checker at www.premierdrive.co.uk/areas. If your postcode falls just outside our zone, we may still be able to accommodate you -- please ask.

Section 4 -- Lesson Packages & Full Pricing List

All prices below are inclusive of VAT. Prices are reviewed annually -- typically each January. Block booking discounts are applied automatically when you book 10 or more hours at once. Prices may vary slightly by postcode -- call us to confirm your area rate.

4.1 Standard Manual Lessons

Package / Service	Price (inc. VAT)
Single 1-hour lesson (manual)	£38
Single 1.5-hour lesson (manual)	£55
Single 2-hour lesson (manual)	£72
Block of 5 hours (manual) -- save £10	£180
Block of 10 hours (manual) -- save £30	£350
Block of 20 hours (manual) -- save £80	£680

4.2 Automatic Lessons

Package / Service	Price (inc. VAT)
Single 1-hour lesson (automatic)	£40
Single 1.5-hour lesson (automatic)	£58
Single 2-hour lesson (automatic)	£75
Block of 5 hours (automatic) -- save £10	£190
Block of 10 hours (automatic) -- save £30	£370
Block of 20 hours (automatic) -- save £80	£720

4.3 Intensive & Crash Courses

Package / Service	Price (inc. VAT)
10-hour intensive course (manual, 1 week)	£360
20-hour intensive course (manual, 2 weeks)	£699
30-hour intensive course (manual, 3 weeks)	£999
40-hour intensive course (manual, 4 weeks)	£1,299
10-hour intensive course (automatic)	£380
30-hour intensive course (automatic)	£1,050

4.4 Other Services

Package / Service	Price (inc. VAT)
Pass Plus (6 modules, ~6 hours)	£185
Motorway lesson (post-test, 1 hour)	£42
Refresher lesson -- 1 hour (licence held)	£40
Refresher lesson -- block of 5 hours	£185
Mock driving test (1 hour with debrief)	£45
Theory test coaching session (2 hours)	£55
Fleet training per driver -- assessment (2 hours)	£90

Fleet training per driver -- full day (6 hours)	£240
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Student Discount: Full-time students (with valid student ID) receive 5% off any block booking of 10 hours or more. Cannot be combined with other offers. Ask your instructor to apply on booking.

Section 5 -- Intensive & Crash Courses

Our intensive courses are designed for pupils who want to pass their driving test quickly -- ideal for students going to university, people who have recently moved to the UK, or anyone who needs their licence urgently. We run intensive courses in Manchester City Centre, Stockport, Oldham, and Bolton.

What Is Included in an Intensive Course?

- All tuition hours with a fully qualified ADI (same instructor throughout your course).
- A structured syllabus covering all DVSA test competencies.
- At least one full mock driving test with written debrief before your test date.
- Advice and support for booking your theory test and practical test.
- Use of our dual-controlled vehicle for your practical test (additional £60 -- see below).
- Progress review after each half-day session.
- Access to PremierDrive app with hazard perception practice videos.

5.1 Course Prerequisites

Before starting an intensive course you **MUST** already hold a valid provisional driving licence. We strongly recommend you have already passed your theory test before starting the intensive practical course, as you cannot book a practical test without a valid theory test pass certificate (valid for 2 years from test date).

Important: We offer Theory Test coaching sessions (£55 for 2 hours) to help you prepare if you have not yet passed the theory test.

5.2 Booking Your Intensive Course

Intensive courses must be booked and paid in full at least 5 days before the course start date. We will agree a suitable week with you and confirm instructor availability. Practical test bookings are arranged by us on your behalf -- DVSA test fees (currently £62 for weekdays or £75 for weekends/evenings) are charged separately and paid directly to DVSA.

5.3 Realistic Expectations

An intensive course compresses many hours of learning into a short period. Most first-time learners will need a minimum of 20-30 hours to be test-ready, regardless of how quickly those hours are taken. PremierDrive will give you an honest assessment after your first day. If more hours are needed, you can top up at the standard hourly rate. We will **NEVER** send you to test before your instructor believes you are ready.

5.4 Using Our Car for Your Test

You may use a PremierDrive vehicle for your practical driving test. The instructor will accompany you to the test centre and wait during your test. This service costs £60 (included in intensive course packages of 30 hours or more). For standalone test accompaniment, the fee is £60 per test.

Section 6 -- Theory Test: What It Is & How to Pass

The theory test is the first of two tests you must pass to earn a full UK driving licence. It tests your knowledge of The Highway Code, traffic signs, road rules, and safe driving. You must pass the theory test before you can book your practical driving test. Your theory test pass certificate is valid for 2 years.

6.1 Theory Test Format

- Part 1 -- Multiple Choice: 50 questions. Pass mark: 43 out of 50.
- Part 2 -- Hazard Perception: 14 video clips (13 with 1 hazard, 1 with 2 hazards = 75 marks total). Pass mark: 44 out of 75.
- Both parts must be passed in the same sitting.
- Total test duration: approximately 57 minutes (3 minutes tutorial + 57 minutes test).
- The test is taken at an authorised DVSA theory test centre.

6.2 How to Book the Theory Test

- Book online at www.gov.uk/book-theory-test or by phone: 0300 200 1122.
- Current theory test fee: £23 (car). Payable directly to DVSA.
- You must have your provisional licence number to book.
- Tests are available Monday-Saturday, typically 8am-6pm.
- Manchester test centres: DVSA Stretford (Trafford), DVSA Oldham.

6.3 Topics Covered in the Multiple Choice Test

Questions are drawn from the following categories:

- Alertness and attitude (approx. 8 questions)
- Safety margins and vehicle handling (approx. 7 questions)
- Road and traffic signs (approx. 8 questions)
- Rules of the road and junctions (approx. 8 questions)
- Motorway rules (approx. 3 questions)
- Vehicle loading, towing, and environmental responsibility (approx. 4 questions)
- Vulnerable road users -- pedestrians, cyclists, motorcyclists (approx. 5 questions)
- Documents and accidents -- first aid, incident procedures (approx. 4 questions)
- Vehicle safety -- lights, tyres, brakes (approx. 3 questions)

6.4 How to Prepare

- Purchase the official DVSA Theory Test Kit app or book (Highway Code + official question bank).
- Use the free gov.uk practice tests at www.gov.uk/theory-test/practice-theory-test.
- Aim for consistent 47-50/50 in mock tests before your real test.
- PremierDrive offers 2-hour Theory Test coaching sessions at £55 -- covers entire question bank strategy.
- Revise road signs carefully -- this is where most pupils lose marks.
- Read The Highway Code from cover to cover at least once.

PremierDrive Tip: Download the official DVSA Theory Test app (available on iOS and Android). Practice for 20-30 minutes every day for 3-4 weeks. Most pupils are ready to pass in 4-6 weeks of consistent daily revision.

Section 7 -- Hazard Perception Test

The Hazard Perception Test (HPT) is Part 2 of the theory test. It measures your ability to identify developing hazards on the road -- situations that require a driver to take action, such as braking, steering, or giving way.

7.1 Test Format

- 14 video clips filmed from a driver's perspective on real UK roads.
- 13 clips contain 1 scoreable hazard each. 1 clip contains 2 scoreable hazards.
- Total: 75 marks available. Pass mark: 44 out of 75.
- Each hazard is scored 0-5. You score more points for clicking earlier as the hazard develops.
- If you click randomly in a pattern, the system detects this and scores that clip 0.

7.2 How to Score Well

- Click as soon as you notice a hazard developing -- e.g. a parked car about to pull out, a pedestrian stepping off the pavement, a junction ahead.
- Click once per developing hazard -- do not click rapidly or repeatedly.
- Look for junctions, pedestrians, cyclists, parked vehicles, emerging vehicles, and bends.
- Practice the official DVSA hazard perception clips -- available in the DVSA app and at gov.uk.
- Aim for 65+ in mock tests before your real test.

7.3 Common Mistakes to Avoid

- Clicking too late -- many pupils see the hazard but wait too long to click.
- Pattern clicking -- clicking every 2 seconds regardless of what is on screen. The system penalises this.
- Missing the "developing" hazard -- something is only a hazard when it requires a driver response.
- Ignoring cyclists and pedestrians near junctions -- these are the most common scoreable hazards.

PremierDrive Tip: Watch each clip 5-10 times in practice. The more familiar you are with how developing hazards look and feel, the quicker your reactions will be in the real test.

Section 8 -- Practical Driving Test: Full Guide

The practical driving test assesses your ability to drive safely and competently on public roads in a variety of real traffic conditions. It is conducted by a DVSA examiner from an approved driving test centre.

8.1 Test Duration & Format

- Total duration: approximately 38-40 minutes of driving.
- The examiner will give directions using a sat-nav device (independent driving) or road signs.
- You will perform 1 or 2 manoeuvres (selected randomly from the current DVSA list).
- The examiner will ask 2 "Show Me Tell Me" vehicle safety questions.
- 1 "Tell Me" question is asked before the test begins.
- 1 "Show Me" question is asked while driving.

8.2 Test Fees

Package / Service	Price (inc. VAT)
Practical test (weekday)	£62
Practical test (evening / weekend)	£75
Extended test (after serious offence)	£124
Motorcycle Module 1 (off-road)	£15.50
Motorcycle Module 2 (on-road)	£75

Test fees are paid directly to DVSA when booking at www.gov.uk/book-driving-test. PremierDrive does not collect DVSA test fees.

8.3 Driving Faults Explained

- Minor fault (driver error): up to 15 minor faults allowed. 16 or more = fail.
- Serious fault (potentially dangerous): 1 serious fault = automatic fail.
- Dangerous fault (actual danger caused): 1 dangerous fault = automatic fail.

8.4 Independent Driving (20 minutes)

For approximately 20 minutes of the test, you will follow directions from a DVSA-approved sat-nav (TomTom) or follow road signs without the examiner directing you. You are not being tested on navigation ability -- it is fine to take a wrong turn as long as you do so safely. The examiner will re-route you.

8.5 Local Test Centres (Manchester)

- DVSA Driving Test Centre -- Ashton-under-Lyne (most common for our pupils)
- DVSA Driving Test Centre -- Stretford, Trafford
- DVSA Driving Test Centre -- Wythenshawe
- DVSA Driving Test Centre -- Stockport
- DVSA Driving Test Centre -- Oldham

Section 9 -- Show Me Tell Me Questions (Full List)

Before and during your practical test, the examiner will ask one "Tell Me" question (asked before you move off) and one "Show Me" question (asked while driving). An incorrect answer counts as one minor fault. Failing both = 2 minor faults. There are currently 19 questions in the DVSA bank -- learn all of them.

TELL ME Questions -- Answered verbally before you move off

Q: Tell me where you'd find the information for the recommended tyre pressures for this car and how you'd check the tyre pressure.

A: Information in the car's handbook. Check using a reliable pressure gauge when tyres are cold.

Q: Tell me how you'd check that the brakes are working before starting a journey.

A: Brakes should not feel spongy or slack. Test them as you move off -- they should not pull to one side.

Q: Tell me how you'd check that the power-assisted steering is working.

A: Gentle resistance felt when turning the steering wheel just after starting the engine confirms it is working.

Q: Tell me how you'd check the tyres are safe to drive on.

A: Check for cuts, bulges, or objects embedded in the tyre. Minimum 1.6mm tread depth across the central three-quarters of the tyre.

Q: Tell me how you'd know if there was a problem with your anti-lock braking system.

A: ABS warning light on the dashboard -- if it stays illuminated after starting, a fault is present.

Q: Tell me how you'd check that the headlights and tail lights are working.

A: Turn them on, walk round the car. If alone, use reflections in a wall or garage door.

Q: Tell me how you'd check the direction indicators are working.

A: Operate the indicators, walk round the car to check all corners flash. Listen for the click.

Q: Tell me how you'd check the brake lights are working.

A: Operate the footbrake, ask someone to check, or use a reflection in a shop window or garage door.

Q: Tell me how you'd check the tyres have sufficient tread depth.

A: Minimum 1.6mm across the central three-quarters of the tyre around the entire circumference. Use a tread depth gauge.

Q: Tell me how you'd check the engine has sufficient oil.

A: With engine cold and on level ground, remove and wipe the dipstick, re-insert, then check the level is between MIN and MAX.

Q: Tell me how you'd check the engine coolant level is correct.

A: Check the coolant reservoir when the engine is cold. Level should be between MIN and MAX markers on the side of the reservoir.

Q: Tell me how you'd check the windscreen washer level is sufficient.

A: Open the bonnet and check the washer fluid reservoir -- marked with a windscreen symbol. Top up if below MIN.

SHOW ME Questions -- Demonstrated while driving

Q: Show me how you'd wash and clean the rear windscreen.

A: Operate the rear wiper/wash control (usually a stalk or button on dashboard).

Q: Show me how you'd wash and clean the front windscreen.

A: Operate the front washer/wiper stalk or switch.

Q: Show me how you'd switch on the rear fog light(s) and explain when you'd use them.

A: Operate the fog light switch. Use when visibility drops below 100 metres (approximately).

Q: Show me how you'd demist the rear windscreen.

A: Operate the heated rear windscreen button (usually a rear screen symbol on dashboard).

Q: Show me how you'd operate the horn.

A: Press the centre of the steering wheel.

Q: Show me how you'd reduce the dazzle to oncoming drivers from your headlights.

A: Switch from full beam (main beam) to dipped headlights using the headlight control/stalk.

Q: Show me how you'd switch your headlights from dipped to full beam.

A: Push the headlight stalk forward (or pull toward you depending on vehicle) to activate main beam.

Section 10 -- Driving Test Manoeuvres

During your practical test, the examiner will ask you to perform one or two of the following manoeuvres. The manoeuvres are selected at random -- you must be competent in all of them. Your instructor will practise each one with you before test day.

10.1 Bay Park (Reverse into a bay)

You may be asked to reverse into a parking bay at the test centre or a car park en route. Pull forward past the bay you wish to reverse into, check mirrors and blind spots, select reverse, and reverse slowly into the bay using reference points. The car must end up reasonably straight and within the bay markings.

10.2 Bay Park (Drive into a bay, reverse out)

Drive forward into a parking bay, then reverse out under control, checking for traffic and pedestrians before and during the manoeuvre.

10.3 Parallel Park at the Roadside

Pull up alongside the vehicle in front of the space, reverse into the gap using smooth steering, and finish close to and parallel with the kerb. The car should be within 2 car lengths of the parked vehicle in front. No mounting the kerb.

10.4 Pull Up on the Right-Hand Side of the Road

Pull up safely on the right-hand side of the road, reverse 2 car lengths, then rejoin the traffic safely. This tests your ability to use a road correctly in unusual circumstances (e.g. if your own driveway is on the right). Check mirrors, signal, check blind spot before pulling out.

10.5 Emergency Stop

The examiner will raise their hand and say "Stop!" -- you must stop as quickly as possible without skidding, as if a child has run into the road. Do not check mirrors before stopping (there is no time in a real emergency). Apply firm, progressive brake pressure. This is only performed in approximately 1 in 3 tests -- not every candidate gets an emergency stop.

10.6 General Tips for Manoeuvres

- Use the MSPSL routine (Mirror - Signal - Position - Speed - Look) before every manoeuvre.
- Observations are critical -- check mirrors, blind spots, and over both shoulders before and during.
- Speed: all manoeuvres should be carried out at a slow, controlled speed using clutch control (manual) or light brake pressure (automatic).
- Reference points: identify the right point to start turning -- practise these consistently.
- If you make an error, you may correct it -- as long as you remain safe.

Section 11 -- Booking Policy

11.1 How to Book Your Lessons

- Online: www.premierdrive.co.uk/book -- available 24/7.
- Phone: 0161 555 0291 -- Mon-Sat 8am-7pm, Sun 9am-1pm.
- Via the PremierDrive app (iOS and Android).
- Your instructor can arrange bookings directly after your first lesson.

11.2 First Lesson Booking

New pupils should book an initial assessment lesson (1 hour recommended). During this session, your instructor will assess your current level, identify any prior experience, and agree a lesson plan. If you have never driven before, we recommend starting with a 1.5-hour first lesson to allow more time for learning the basics without feeling rushed.

11.3 Lesson Confirmation

All booked lessons are confirmed by text/email within 24 hours. You will receive a reminder 48 hours before your lesson and again 2 hours before your lesson. If you have not received confirmation within 24 hours, contact us -- do not assume the booking is confirmed.

11.4 Changing Your Instructor

If for any reason you wish to change your instructor, contact PremierDrive office and we will arrange this at no extra charge. You do not need to give a reason. Continuity of instructor is beneficial but not mandatory -- we will do our best to match you with an instructor who has reviewed your previous lesson notes.

11.5 Availability & Waiting Times

Lesson availability varies by area and time of year. During school holidays and at peak times (July-September), waiting times may be 1-2 weeks for a first lesson. Block-bookers and intensive course pupils are given priority scheduling. Evening and weekend slots fill up fastest -- book early if you need specific times.

11.6 Lesson Duration

Standard lessons are 1 hour, 1.5 hours, or 2 hours. You can mix durations in a block. Lessons run for the full booked time -- instructors will not cut lessons short. If an instructor arrives late due to traffic or a previous lesson overrun, the lesson will be extended accordingly or credited to your account.

Section 12 -- Cancellation & Rescheduling Policy

IMPORTANT: Our cancellation policy exists to protect both pupils and instructors. Short-notice cancellations prevent us from offering that slot to other pupils. Please read this section carefully before booking.

12.1 Cancellation by Pupil

- More than 48 hours notice: Full credit to your lesson account. No charge.
- Between 24 and 48 hours notice: 50% of the lesson fee charged (or 50% of hourly block rate deducted).
- Less than 24 hours notice: Full lesson fee charged (or full hour deducted from block).
- No-show (no contact, no attendance): Full lesson fee charged. Repeat no-shows may result in account suspension.

12.2 How to Cancel

- Via the PremierDrive app -- quickest method, timestamp logged automatically.
- By text to your instructor's number.
- By phone: 0161 555 0291 (office hours Mon-Sat 8am-7pm).
- Email: cancellations@premierdrive.co.uk.
- Important: cancellation by text/app is only confirmed when you receive a reply. If you do not get a reply within 2 hours, call the office.

12.3 Rescheduling

You may reschedule a lesson at any time up to 48 hours before the lesson at no charge. Rescheduling within 48 hours is treated as a short-notice cancellation -- the original lesson is charged at the appropriate rate and the new lesson is booked at full price.

12.4 Cancellation by Instructor

In the rare event your instructor needs to cancel, we will notify you as soon as possible. We will offer you an alternative slot with your instructor or an alternative qualified instructor. If we cannot find a replacement within 48 hours of the original lesson time, the lesson will be credited in full with an additional 10% discount on your next booking as an apology.

12.5 Emergency Cancellations (Illness / Severe Weather)

If you or a member of your household falls ill on the day of a lesson, we will not charge for the cancellation provided you notify us before the lesson start time and provide a brief explanation. Severe weather (e.g. heavy snow, ice) may result in lesson suspension by the instructor -- pupils will be notified and lessons credited in full.

Section 13 -- Payment Terms & Refund Policy

13.1 Accepted Payment Methods

- Card payment (Visa, Mastercard, Amex) -- via secure online portal or app.
- Bank transfer (BACS) -- bank details provided on invoice.
- Cash -- accepted at first lesson (please bring exact amount).
- PayPal -- available via website checkout.
- Instalment plans -- available for intensive courses of 20 hours or more (contact office).

13.2 When to Pay

- Single lessons: pay within 24 hours of booking confirmation, or at the start of the lesson in cash.
- Block bookings: full payment required at point of booking to secure the block.
- Intensive courses: full payment required 5 days before course start. Deposit of 30% accepted on booking, remainder due 5 days before start.

13.3 Refund Policy

- Unused lesson hours from a block booking may be refunded on request, less any lessons already used and less a £15 admin fee.
- Intensive courses: up to 50% refund if cancelled more than 10 days before course start. No refund within 5 days of start.
- Test accompaniment/use of car (£60): fully refundable if test is cancelled with more than 5 days notice. Non-refundable otherwise.
- PremierDrive reserves the right to withhold refunds where lessons have been cancelled repeatedly with less than 24 hours notice.
- Refunds are processed within 5 working days of the refund request.

13.4 Invoices & Receipts

A receipt or invoice is automatically emailed after every payment. Block booking invoices are available in the PremierDrive app under Account > Payments. If you need a VAT invoice for business expense purposes, request one at info@premierdrive.co.uk. PremierDrive VAT Registration Number: GB 294 7761 33.

Section 14 -- Eligibility, Legal Requirements & Medical Fitness

14.1 Minimum Age

- Car (manual or automatic): minimum age 17.
- Car with mobility allowance (DLA/PIP at higher rate): minimum age 16.
- Moped (50cc): minimum age 16.
- Motorcycle: minimum age 17 (Compulsory Basic Training required first).

14.2 Provisional Driving Licence

You must hold a valid GB provisional driving licence before you can legally drive on a public road. Apply at www.gov.uk/apply-first-provisional-driving-licence (£34 fee, paid to DVLA). You will need a UK passport, biometric residence permit, or birth certificate, and a digital passport photo. Allow 1-3 weeks for delivery.

14.3 Eyesight Requirements

You must be able to read a standard number plate from 20 metres in good daylight (with glasses or contact lenses if required). This is checked at the start of your practical test. If you wear glasses or lenses, you **MUST** wear them during all lessons and the driving test. Inform your instructor if your prescription has changed.

14.4 Medical Conditions

Certain medical conditions must be reported to the DVLA. These include epilepsy, severe mental health conditions, uncontrolled diabetes, cardiac conditions, sleep apnoea, and others. See www.gov.uk/health-conditions-and-driving for the full list. Failure to declare a relevant condition is a criminal offence and can invalidate your insurance. PremierDrive instructors are not medically qualified -- consult your GP if unsure.

Section 15 -- What to Bring to Your Lesson

15.1 Essential Documents

- Your GB provisional driving licence (photocard) -- **REQUIRED AT EVERY LESSON**. We cannot legally allow you to drive without it.
- Glasses or contact lenses if you need them for driving.
- Comfortable, flat-soled shoes -- avoid flip-flops, high heels, or thick-soled boots.

15.2 Recommended Items

- A notepad and pen -- for writing down your instructor's feedback.
- PremierDrive app (downloaded and logged in) -- to view lesson notes and progress reports.
- Water bottle -- lessons can be mentally tiring.

15.3 What NOT to Bring

- Mobile phones must be out of reach and switched to silent during driving. You must not use a handheld device while driving -- this is a legal requirement and will result in immediate termination of the lesson.
- Bulky bags that obstruct the footwell or driver's position.
- Pets or other passengers without instructor permission.

Section 16 -- Automatic vs Manual Lessons

16.1 The Key Difference

Manual cars have a clutch pedal and gear stick -- you must change gears yourself. Automatic cars change gear automatically -- there is no clutch pedal and no gear stick (just Drive, Neutral, Park, and Reverse modes). Automatic lessons are easier to learn initially but carry an important restriction.

16.2 Licence Restriction

If you pass your driving test in an automatic car, your licence is restricted to automatic vehicles only. You cannot legally drive a manual car unless you pass a further test in a manual vehicle. There is NO restriction the other way -- if you pass in a manual, you can drive both manual and automatic cars.

16.3 Who Should Choose Automatic?

- Pupils with certain disabilities or medical conditions affecting their left leg, foot, or coordination -- automatic removes the clutch entirely.
- Older learners who find clutch control difficult.
- Pupils who only ever intend to drive automatic vehicles (increasingly common as EVs become mainstream -- all electric vehicles are automatic).
- Pupils who have tried manual and find clutch control a significant barrier.
- Pupils who need to pass quickly and are comfortable with the licence restriction.

16.4 Who Should Choose Manual?

- Anyone who may want to drive a wider range of vehicles now or in the future.
- Young learners -- extra time to learn the clutch is worthwhile for the unrestricted licence.
- Anyone planning to work in a role where driving different vehicles is required (delivery, logistics, care work).

16.5 Can I Switch Mid-Course?

Yes -- you can switch from manual to automatic or vice versa at any point in your course. Some skills transfer directly (road positioning, observations, manoeuvres) but clutch control must be learned from scratch if switching to manual. Hours already taken do not transfer between vehicle types in terms of pricing -- the hourly rate for the new vehicle type applies going forward.

PremierDrive recommends manual lessons for most new learners unless there is a specific reason for automatic. Speak to your instructor at your assessment lesson -- they will advise based on your specific situation.

Section 17 -- How Many Lessons Will I Need?

This is the question we are asked most often. The honest answer is: it varies significantly from person to person. The DVSA's own research indicates that the average new driver needs 45 hours of professional lessons plus 22 hours of private practice to reach test standard. PremierDrive pupils average 35-40 professional hours -- better than the national average, reflecting our structured approach.

17.1 Factors That Affect Hours Required

- Prior experience: if you have driven legally with parents or other supervisors, you may progress faster.
- Natural aptitude: some people develop spatial awareness and coordination faster than others -- this is normal and not a reflection of intelligence.
- Lesson frequency: pupils who take lessons more frequently (e.g. twice a week) typically need fewer total hours because skills are retained better between sessions.
- Quality of private practice: supplementing lessons with supervised private practice in a suitable car speeds up progress.
- Manual vs automatic: clutch control is a major hurdle for many manual learners and can add 5-10 hours.
- Local roads: test routes in busy city areas (e.g. Manchester city centre) are more complex than rural routes and take more hours to master.
- Anxiety: driving anxiety is common and manageable, but can slow progress. Inform your instructor -- we have specific techniques for anxious learners.

17.2 Approximate Hour Estimates by Starting Level

Package / Service	Price (inc. VAT)
Complete beginner (no prior experience)	40-50 professional hours
Some private practice (5-10 hours supervised)	30-40 professional hours
Previous learner (lapsed or previously failed test)	15-25 professional hours
Overseas licence holder (needs UK test)	10-20 professional hours
Refresher driver (full licence, returning after break)	5-10 professional hours

17.3 Test Readiness -- Our Promise

PremierDrive will never book your practical test until your instructor confirms you are test-ready. "Test-ready" means you can complete a full mock driving test with 5 or fewer minor faults and zero serious or dangerous faults -- consistently, over at least 3 separate mock tests. You will be shown your mock test result sheets so you can see exactly where you are.

17.4 How to Maximise Your Progress

- Take lessons at least once a week -- twice a week if you can afford it.
- Take private practice between lessons with a qualified supervisor in a suitable insured vehicle.
- Revise The Highway Code and theory questions daily.
- Review your lesson notes in the PremierDrive app after every session.
- Be honest with your instructor about what you found difficult -- do not pretend to understand something if you did not.

Section 18 -- Pass Plus Programme

Pass Plus is an optional post-test training course developed by the DVSA to help newly qualified drivers gain confidence and experience in road conditions not covered in the standard driving test. It typically takes around 6 hours to complete and is done with a qualified ADI after you have passed your practical test.

18.1 Pass Plus Modules (6 in Total)

- Module 1 -- Town Driving: navigating complex junctions, one-way systems, bus lanes, and congestion.
- Module 2 -- Rural Roads: country roads, bends, narrow lanes, agricultural vehicles, speed awareness.
- Module 3 -- Driving in All Weathers: rain, fog, ice, bright sunshine -- adjusting speed and technique.
- Module 4 -- Night Driving: headlight use, hazard identification at night, speed and stopping distance.
- Module 5 -- Dual Carriageways: joining, lane discipline, overtaking safely, exiting.
- Module 6 -- Motorway Driving: joining, lane discipline, variable speed limits, smart motorways, motorway service areas.

18.2 Cost

Package / Service	Price (inc. VAT)
Pass Plus (all 6 modules, approx. 6 hours)	£185
Pass Plus -- individual modules (per hour)	£42

18.3 Insurance Discount

Most UK insurers offer a discount of 5%-35% off your car insurance premium for passing Pass Plus. The discount varies by insurer. Given that new driver insurance can cost £1,500-£3,000+ per year, the saving often more than covers the cost of the course. Check with your insurer before booking to confirm the discount amount.

18.4 Who Is Pass Plus For?

- All newly qualified drivers -- particularly those who passed their test on a local route and lack motorway or dual carriageway experience.
- Young drivers (17-25) who face the highest insurance premiums and would benefit most from the insurance discount.
- Anyone who avoided night driving or motorways during their lessons.

18.5 Does Pass Plus Replace Motorway Lessons?

Pass Plus Module 6 covers motorway driving. However, we also offer standalone motorway lessons (post-test) at £42/hour for drivers who want more motorway-specific practice beyond what Pass Plus covers. See Section 19 for details.

Section 19 -- Motorway Driving Lessons

Since June 2018, learner drivers are legally permitted to drive on motorways under the supervision of an Approved Driving Instructor (ADI) in a vehicle fitted with dual controls. This is an excellent opportunity to gain motorway experience before your test.

19.1 Motorway Lessons for Learners (Pre-Test)

- Available to pupils aged 17+ who have a valid provisional licence.
- Must be at a suitable stage of training -- your instructor will advise when you are ready.
- Cost: standard hourly rate (£38 manual / £40 automatic) -- no surcharge.
- Cannot be booked as a first lesson -- only available to existing PremierDrive pupils.

19.2 Motorway Lessons for Qualified Drivers (Post-Test)

- Available to anyone with a full UK driving licence.
- Ideal after passing your test if you have never driven on a motorway.
- Cost: £42/hour.
- Covers: joining from slip roads, safe following distances, lane discipline, smart motorway rules, exiting safely.

19.3 Smart Motorway Safety

All motorway lessons include a briefing on smart motorway operation: variable speed limits displayed on overhead gantries, active traffic management (ATM), and what to do if your vehicle breaks down on a smart motorway (reach a refuge area, call 999 if unable to move).

Section 20 -- Refresher Lessons for Experienced Drivers

Refresher lessons are for drivers who hold a full UK licence but have not driven for some time, lack confidence, or want to update their skills after a change in circumstances (e.g. returning from living abroad, recovering from illness, changing from automatic to manual).

20.1 Who Needs Refresher Lessons?

- Drivers returning to driving after 1 or more years off the road.
- New parents who want to regain confidence before driving with a child.
- Drivers who failed their test and want to take additional lessons before rebooking.
- Overseas licence holders preparing to take the UK practical test.
- Employees whose employer requires a driving assessment.
- Drivers with penalty points who want to improve their skills as part of a remedial programme.

20.2 What Refresher Lessons Cover

- Initial assessment: identifying current skill level and any specific gaps.
- Clutch control and gear changes (manual drivers).
- Junction observations, roundabouts, and complex road situations.
- Parking manoeuvres and reversing.
- Motorway and dual carriageway driving (if required).
- Highway Code update -- particularly new rules on cycling and pedestrian priority.

Package / Service	Price (inc. VAT)
Refresher -- 1-hour single lesson	£40

Refresher -- block of 5 hours	£185
Refresher -- block of 10 hours (save £30)	£370

Section 21 -- Fleet & Business Driver Training

PremierDrive offers structured fleet and business driver training for organisations in Greater Manchester. Whether you need to assess new employees, upskill existing drivers, or reduce fleet insurance costs and accident rates, we can provide a tailored programme.

21.1 Fleet Training Services

Package / Service	Price (inc. VAT)
Driver risk assessment (2 hours, 1 driver)	£90
Full-day improvement training (6 hours, 1 driver)	£240
Group assessment report (3-5 drivers)	£350
Annual fleet assessment programme (per driver, quarterly)	POA -- call for quote
DVSA-aligned driver CPC (periodic training, per day)	£110 per delegate

21.2 What the Driver Risk Assessment Covers

- On-road driving assessment: 60-90 minutes covering motorway, town, dual carriageway, and rural roads where applicable.
- Written report: detailed feedback on driver performance against DVSA National Standard criteria.
- Risk rating: Low / Medium / High -- with specific recommendations for remedial training.
- Suitable for: new employee vetting, post-accident assessment, returning-from-injury assessment, licence restoration compliance.

21.3 Driver CPC -- Periodic Training

Professional lorry, bus, and coach drivers in the UK require 35 hours of periodic Driver CPC training every 5 years to maintain their professional driving licence. PremierDrive provides DVSA-approved periodic CPC training in 7-hour day modules. Topics available include: safe and fuel-efficient driving, load safety, health and wellbeing, emergency first aid, and tachograph rules. Contact info@premierdrive.co.uk for a full training calendar and group bookings.

21.4 Fleet Training Booking

Fleet and business training must be booked by emailing fleet@premierdrive.co.uk or calling 0161 555 0291 and asking for the fleet team. A tailored quote and training plan will be provided within 2 working days. Payment terms for businesses: 30 days from invoice.

Section 22 -- Special Needs & Disability Support

PremierDrive is committed to making driving tuition accessible to all learners. We work with pupils with a wide range of disabilities and learning differences, including visual impairments (where eligible), physical disabilities, autism spectrum conditions (ASC), ADHD, dyslexia, anxiety disorders, and hearing impairments.

22.1 Adapted Vehicles

We have access to specialist adapted vehicles for pupils who require them. Adaptations available (subject to assessment) include: hand controls (for pupils who cannot use foot pedals), steering ball / spinner knob, left-foot accelerator, electronic parking brake, and reduced-effort steering. Please contact us in advance so we can match you with the right vehicle and instructor.

22.2 Learners with Autism / ADHD / Anxiety

- We offer longer initial assessment sessions (1.5 or 2 hours) to allow more time to build rapport without the pressure of a short lesson.
- Instructors experienced in working with anxious or neurodiverse learners are available -- please request at booking.
- We can adapt lesson structure: e.g. spending more time in quiet residential roads before progressing to busier routes.
- Written lesson summaries in the app can be shared with parents, carers, or support workers.
- Quiet time between instruction and action is always available -- your instructor will never rush you.

22.3 Deaf and Hard-of-Hearing Learners

Deaf and hard-of-hearing learners can legally drive in the UK provided they meet all other DVSA eligibility requirements. Instructions can be given via written note cards, visual signals, or lip reading (with instructor's consent). Please discuss your specific needs at the time of booking.

22.4 Applying for Extended Test Time (Theory Test)

If you have a reading or learning difficulty, you may be entitled to extra time, a voiceover option, or a British Sign Language version of the theory test. Apply for special arrangements when booking your theory test via the DVSA at 0300 200 1122. Supporting documentation (e.g. GP letter, Educational Psychologist report) will be required.

22.5 DVLA Medical Queries

If you are unsure whether a medical condition affects your eligibility to drive, contact DVLA Medical Enquiries: 0300 790 6806 (Mon-Fri 8am-5:30pm). See also: www.gov.uk/health-conditions-and-driving. PremierDrive instructors cannot advise on medical eligibility -- this must come from DVLA.

Section 23 -- Frequently Asked Questions: General

Q: Can I use my parent's car for lessons?

A: No. Lessons must be conducted in a PremierDrive dual-controlled vehicle. This is a legal requirement -- only ADIs and PDIs may give paid instruction, and only in approved vehicles. You may practise in your parent's car between lessons with a supervising driver (aged 21+, full licence for 3+ years, car insured for learner drivers).

Q: Can my parent sit in during a lesson?

A: No. Our lesson vehicles seat only the pupil and instructor. Insurance and safeguarding protocols do not permit additional passengers during lessons.

Q: Do I have to pass my theory test before starting lessons?

A: No. You can take driving lessons before passing your theory test. However, you MUST pass your theory test before you can book your practical driving test. We recommend starting lessons and theory revision simultaneously.

Q: What happens if I fail my practical test?

A: You can rebook the practical test after 10 working days. You may rebook as many times as needed -- there is no limit. Your instructor will discuss any weak areas with you and we will arrange additional lessons before your next attempt.

Q: What car will I learn in?

A: We primarily teach in Ford Fiesta (manual) and Volkswagen Golf Automatic. Both are compact, easy to manoeuvre, and popular with first-time learners. Some instructors use a Toyota Yaris or Vauxhall Corsa -- your specific vehicle will be confirmed at booking.

Q: Can I request a female instructor?

A: Yes. We have qualified female ADIs in several Manchester areas. Availability may be limited -- please request at booking and we will do our best to accommodate you.

Q: What if I need to use the toilet during a lesson?

A: Simply tell your instructor -- we will pull over safely and find the nearest suitable facility. Lessons are not timed in a way that penalises short breaks for genuine need.

Q: Is there a maximum age for learning to drive?

A: No. There is no upper age limit for learning to drive or holding a driving licence in the UK. However, from age 70, your licence must be renewed every 3 years and you must confirm you are medically fit to drive.

Q: Can I bring my lesson forward if I improve faster than expected?

A: Yes -- speak to your instructor or call the office. If you are progressing well and feel ready for test sooner than planned, we can schedule a mock test and bring the practical test booking date forward, subject to DVSA availability.

Q: What is a mock driving test?

A: A mock test (£45) is a full-length practice test conducted by your instructor under real test conditions -- including manoeuvres and independent driving. You receive a written fault analysis sheet at the end. We recommend at least 2 mock tests before your real test.

Section 24 -- Frequently Asked Questions: Tests & Licensing

Q: How do I book my theory test?

A: Book online at www.gov.uk/book-theory-test or by phone on 0300 200 1122. You will need your provisional licence number. The current fee is £23, paid directly to DVSA. Theory tests in Manchester are available at the Stretford and Oldham DVSA centres.

Q: How long is the theory test pass certificate valid?

A: 2 years from the date you passed the theory test. If you do not pass your practical test within 2 years, you must retake the theory test before you can book a new practical test.

Q: What ID do I need to bring to the theory test?

A: Your provisional GB photocard driving licence. No other ID is accepted. If your name has changed (e.g. after marriage) and the licence does not reflect this, contact DVLA to update it before attending.

Q: What ID do I need to bring to the practical test?

A: Your provisional GB photocard driving licence. You no longer need to bring your theory test pass certificate on the day -- the DVSA verifies this electronically. However, your instructor should confirm this is still the case on the day of your test.

Q: Can I use my phone as a sat-nav during the independent driving section?

A: No. The examiner will use a DVSA-approved TomTom sat-nav device mounted to the windscreen. You do not need to bring your own. You are NOT permitted to use a mobile phone during the test.

Q: What happens if I stall during the test?

A: Stalling is not an automatic fail. Stalling in a potentially dangerous situation (e.g. at a busy junction, causing other drivers to react) may result in a serious or dangerous fault. Stalling in a safe location and restarting promptly is unlikely to incur more than a minor fault.

Q: Can I drive immediately after passing my test?

A: Yes -- you are fully licensed the moment the examiner confirms you have passed. However, you must be insured. Make sure you have appropriate insurance arranged before you drive without your instructor. Driving uninsured is illegal and can result in fines, points, and disqualification.

Q: Do I get my full licence straight away after passing?

A: Your instructor will give you your Pass Certificate (D10) immediately. The DVSA sends your full photocard licence to your DVLA address within 3 weeks. In the meantime, keep your Pass Certificate and provisional licence -- these prove your entitlement to drive.

Q: My UK licence expired -- do I need to retake the test?

A: No -- you simply need to renew your licence. Licence renewal (from age 70, or after certain conditions) does not require retesting. Apply at www.gov.uk/renew-driving-licence.

Q: I have a foreign driving licence -- can I drive in the UK?

A: Visitors with a licence from an EU/EEA country or a "recognised" country (e.g. Australia, USA) can drive in the UK for up to 12 months on their foreign licence. After 12 months UK residency, you must exchange to a UK licence or take the UK test, depending on your country. See www.gov.uk/driving-nongb-licence for the full list.

Q: What happens if I have a serious medical episode at the wheel?

A: If a medical condition affects your ability to drive safely, you have a legal obligation to stop driving and inform DVLA. Your licence will be assessed -- it may be suspended pending investigation or

restricted. Failing to inform DVLA of a relevant condition is an offence and may invalidate your insurance.

Q: What is the penalty for driving with a provisional licence without a supervisor?

A: Driving unsupervised on a provisional licence carries up to 6 penalty points and a fine of up to £1,000. If you are less than 2 years into your full licence and receive 6 or more penalty points, your licence will be revoked automatically under the New Drivers Act 1995.

Q: How many times can I fail the driving test?

A: There is no legal limit on the number of test attempts. However, we recommend taking additional lessons after each failed attempt before retesting. Your instructor will review your test report (provided by the examiner) to identify the specific faults and create a remedial lesson plan.

Q: What is the New Drivers Act?

A: Under the Road Traffic (New Drivers) Act 1995, new drivers who accumulate 6 or more penalty points within 2 years of passing their test have their licence automatically revoked by DVLA. They must then re-apply for a provisional licence and pass both the theory and practical tests again before driving legally. This applies even if the offences were minor speeding offences.

Q: What is the Highway Code and do I need to buy it?

A: The Highway Code is the official rulebook for UK roads. It is available free online at www.gov.uk/highway-code. A printed version is available in bookshops for around £4. All theory test questions are drawn directly from the Highway Code, DVSA guidance, and Know Your Traffic Signs. Reading the Highway Code is essential preparation for both the theory and practical tests.

Section 25 -- Contact Details, Branches & Opening Hours

25.1 Main Office

PremierDrive School of Motoring -- Head Office
14 King Street, Manchester, M2 6AZ

Main Phone: 0161 555 0291
Out-of-Hours: 07712 900 338 (evenings/weekends -- urgent only)
Email (General): info@premierdrive.co.uk
Email (Fleet): fleet@premierdrive.co.uk
Email (Cancellations): cancellations@premierdrive.co.uk
Website: www.premierdrive.co.uk
Book Online: www.premierdrive.co.uk/book
App: Search "PremierDrive" on iOS App Store or Google Play

25.2 Branch Offices

Branch	Address	Phone
Manchester South (Didsbury)	48 Wilmslow Road, Didsbury, M20 2BQ	0161 555 0381
Stockport	22 Princes Street, Stockport, SK1 1RY	0161 555 0292
Oldham	9 Union Street, Oldham, OL1 1HA	0161 555 0417
Bolton	5 Newport Street, Bolton, BL1 2DZ	01204 555 0183

25.3 Opening Hours

Day	Hours
Monday - Friday	8:00am - 7:00pm
Saturday	8:00am - 5:00pm
Sunday	9:00am - 1:00pm (limited appointments only)
Bank Holidays	Closed -- emergencies: 07712 900 338

25.4 Social Media

- Facebook: facebook.com/PremierDriveMCR
- Instagram: [@premierdrive_mcr](https://www.instagram.com/premierdrive_mcr)
- Google: Search "PremierDrive Manchester" for our Google Business page and reviews.

25.5 Complaints & Compliments

If you are unhappy with any aspect of your experience with PremierDrive, please contact our Customer Experience Manager at complaints@premierdrive.co.uk or call 0161 555 0291 and ask for the manager. All complaints are acknowledged within 24 hours and resolved within 5 working days. We take all feedback seriously and use it to improve our service. If you are happy with your experience, we would love a Google review -- ask your instructor for the link.

25.6 Emergency Contact

If you have a breakdown or incident during a lesson, your instructor will handle all communication with

www.premierdrive.co.uk | info@premierdrive.co.uk | 0161 555 0291

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